



Bartar

A human-centered redesign of a language-school learning app — where digital tools build understanding and confidence, and the teacher stays in the loop.

Bartar's classrooms now run on online platforms, AI translators and writing tools. The risk isn't access — it's that these tools can confuse learners, encourage passive copying, and give inconsistent feedback. This project reframes that as a design problem and answers it with tools that are usable, accessible, and aligned with teacher-guided learning.

AUTHOR

Samaneh Shirinnezhad

ROLE

UX & UI design, interaction design, prototyping

CONTEXT

Bartar Language School · learners of mixed age & level

FOCUS

Human-Computer Interaction · accessibility · educational technology

DELIVERABLES

Clickable prototype · product brief · annotated screens

PLATFORM

iOS / Android · teacher & student roles



Understanding over access

Tools help learners think, not copy. Support is graduated, never instant answers.



Teacher in the loop

AI drafts; the teacher approves. Feedback stays human and consistent.



Confidence is a metric

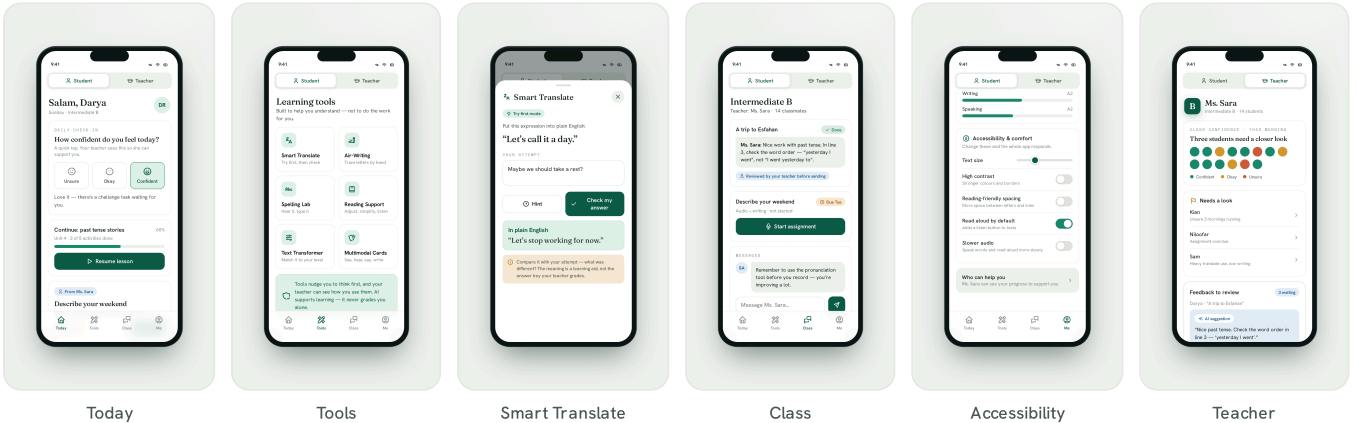
Daily check-ins make confidence visible to learner and teacher alike.



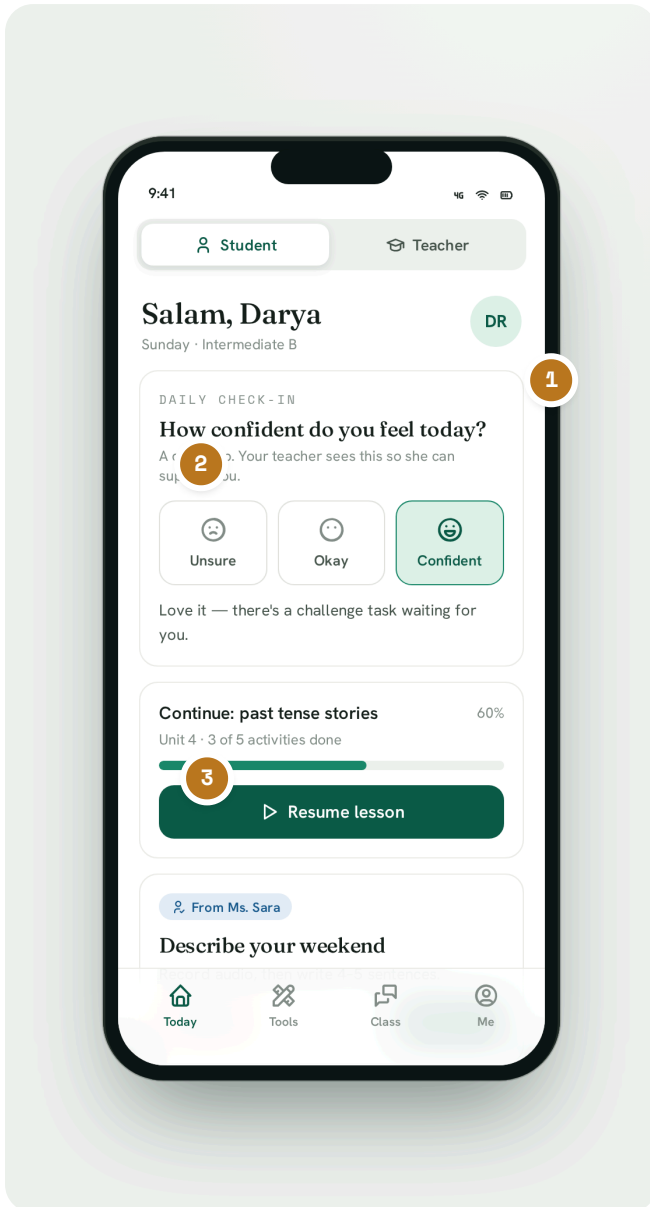
Accessible by default

Text size, contrast, spacing and audio are one tap away and change the whole app.

THE APP AT A GLANCE



→ The pages that follow take four of these screens apart — each decision set against the goal it answers.



Today

The home screen opens not with a streak or a leaderboard, but with a question about how the learner feels — setting a calm, supportive tone for the day.

1 A check-in, not a quiz

Before any lesson, the learner taps how confident they feel. It measures confidence and readiness — not just whether a task was completed.

HCI · EXPERIENCE & CONFIDENCE MEASUREMENT

ANSWERS “measure comprehension, confidence, usability.”

2 The learner is told who sees it

A plain line explains the check-in is shared with the teacher so help can be human. Support is designed in, and so is transparency.

HCI · SUPPORTED USE & TRANSPARENCY

ANSWERS “people do not use technology alone.”

3 One clear next step

“Resume” returns to the exact spot; the teacher's task is named and dated. Nothing is left to guesswork or hidden menus.

HCI · GUIDED WORKFLOW

ANSWERS “guided workflows... aligned with teacher-guided learning.”

DESIGN TAKEAWAY

When the first thing an app asks is how you feel, technology starts from care — and the teacher is never out of reach.

Smart Translate

A translation tool is where copy-paste habits form. This one is rebuilt around a single rule: try first, reveal second.

1 The answer is locked until you try

“Try-first mode” asks for the learner's own attempt before any model answer appears, turning a shortcut into a thinking step.

HCI · DESIGNING AGAINST MISUSE

ANSWERS “encourage passive copying.”

2 A hint before the answer

Support is graduated — a hint nudges before the full meaning is shown, so the learner stays in the work rather than skipping to the result.

HCI · SCAFFOLDING

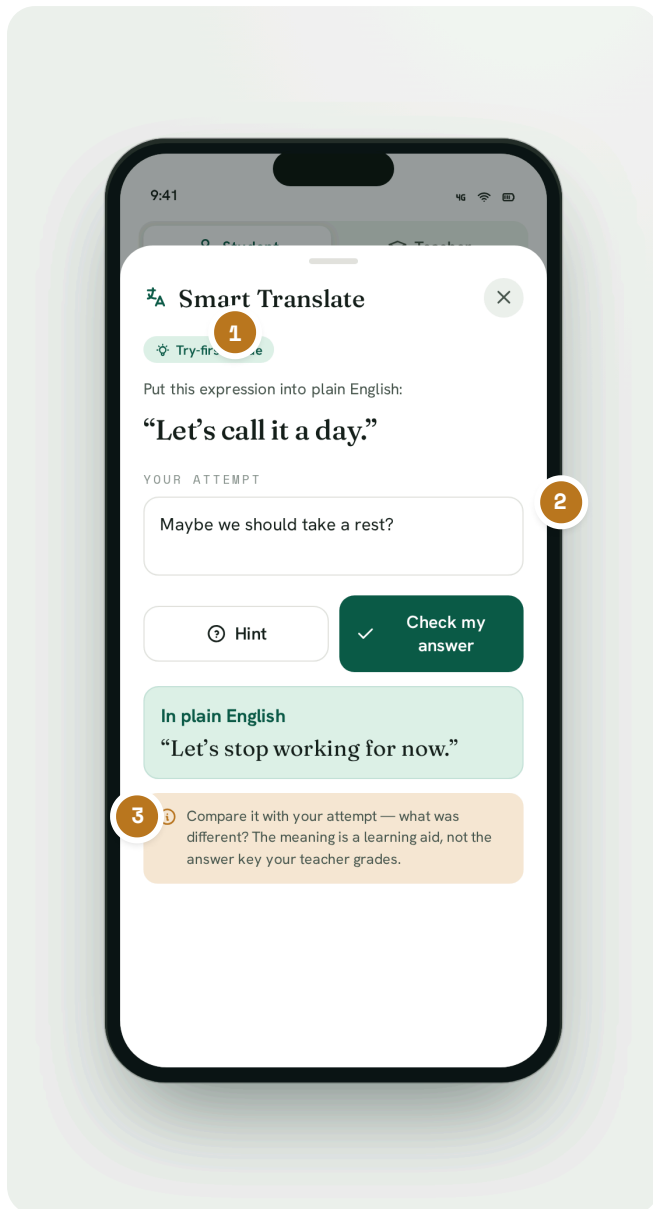
ANSWERS “support comprehension... in more flexible ways.”

3 The tool names its own limits

A note states plainly that the meaning is a learning aid, not the grade — calibrating trust in the AI instead of overselling it.

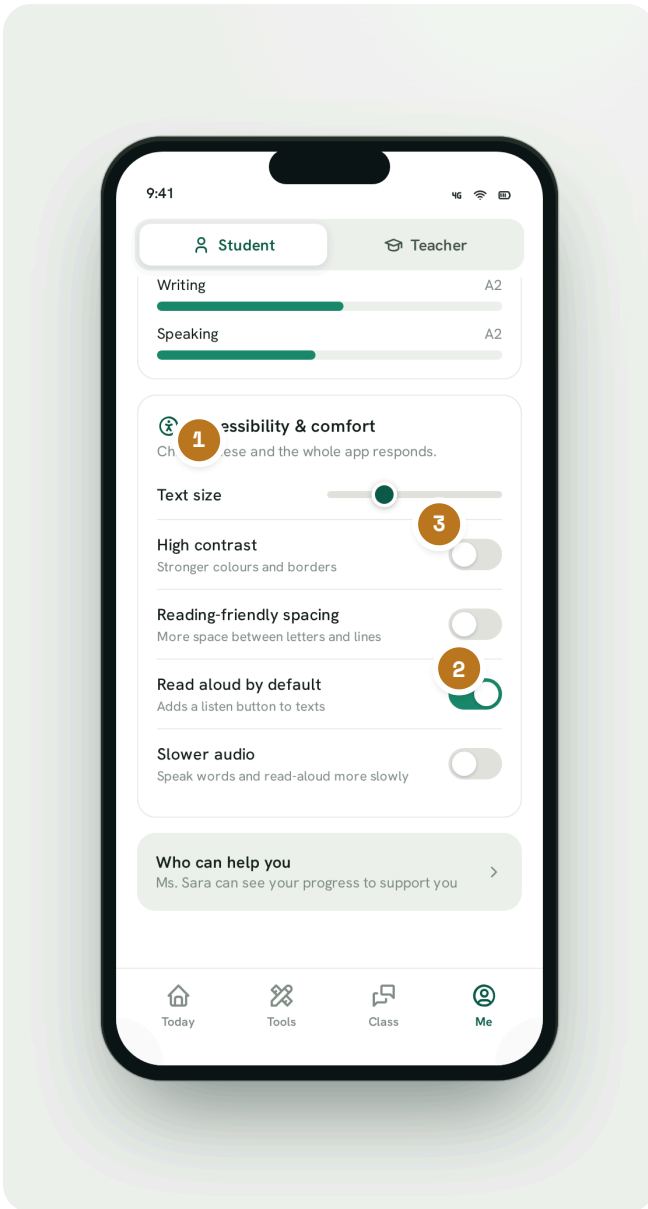
HCI · TRUST & CALIBRATION

ANSWERS “trust... and acting on digital information.”



DESIGN TAKEAWAY

A translator that makes you try first turns a shortcut into a thinking step — and stays honest about what it can't judge.



Accessibility & comfort

Accessibility isn't a buried setting baked in by the designer — it's a panel the learner owns, and every change is reflected across the app live.

1 The learner sets the terms

Text size, contrast, letter spacing and audio speed are all one tap away — and apply instantly to every screen, not just this one.

HCI · ACCESSIBILITY & USER CONTROL

ANSWERS “accessible... usable for the users it is designed to support.”

2 Comfort, framed in plain words

Each control is named by what it does for the person — “stronger colours” — never by a technical label the learner has to decode.

HCI · PLAIN-LANGUAGE INTERFACE

ANSWERS “explanation, trust, usability.”

3 Confidence made visible, gently

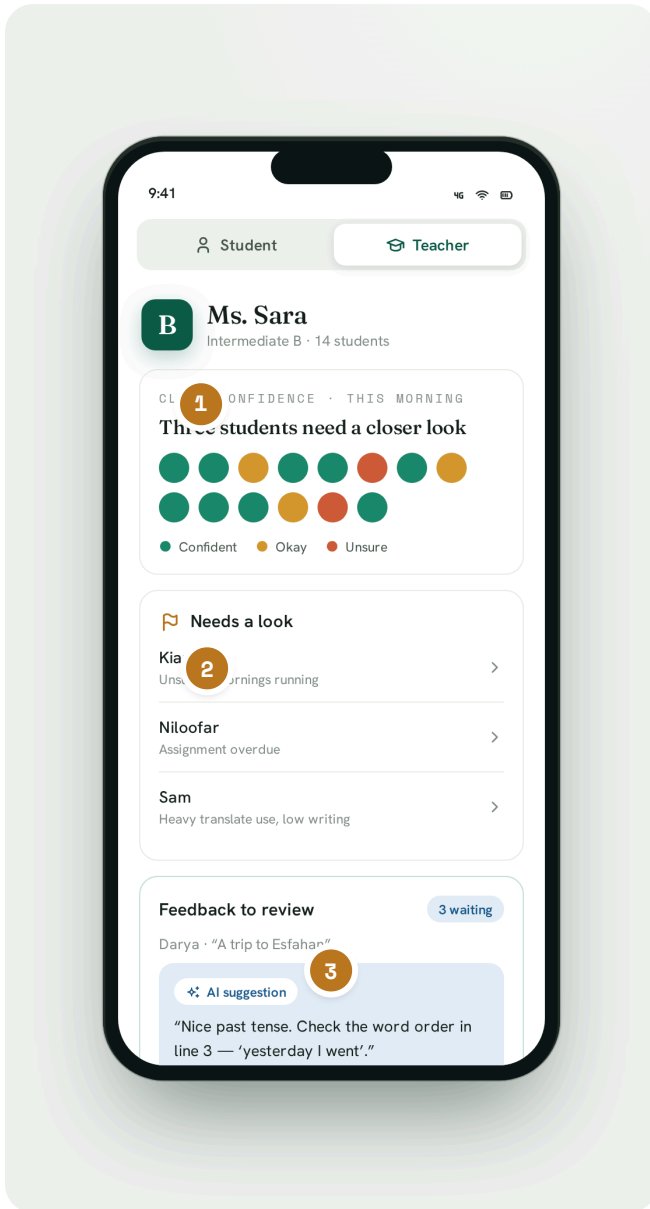
A six-week trend reflects progress back to the learner — encouragement without streaks or pressure that could discourage.

HCI · FEEDBACK WITHOUT DISCOURAGEMENT

ANSWERS “feedback without confusing or discouraging users.”

DESIGN TAKEAWAY

Accessibility designed as a control the learner holds, not a default chosen for them, is accessibility that actually gets used.



Teacher dashboard

The same data the student app collects becomes the teacher's support layer — turning scattered signals into one calm, actionable view.

1 The class at a glance

Morning check-ins become a confidence map, surfacing who needs attention before it ever shows up in a grade.

HCI · INFORMATION VISUALIZATION

ANSWERS “technologies for special populations... information visualization.”

2 Flags that explain themselves

“Heavy translate use, low writing” reframes tool-usage as a teaching signal — guidance for the teacher, not surveillance of the student.

HCI · RESPONSIBLE ANALYTICS

ANSWERS “responsible technology use.”

3 Human in the loop

AI drafts feedback; the teacher edits or approves it before it reaches a student — keeping feedback consistent and accountable.

HCI · HUMAN-AI COLLABORATION

ANSWERS “create inconsistent feedback.”

DESIGN TAKEAWAY

The same signals that guide a learner can support a teacher — when they inform a person's judgement instead of replacing it.